About this writing sample

This two-part procedure explains a prompt-based tool that builds simple programming commands, which modify large data files before importing them. I worked closely with the development team to learn and test the tool while writing the instructions.

Redactions: The application name was changed to TaxApp. Links are styled for visibility and disabled.

Building Rule Sets

A Rule Set contains instructions (Rules and Conditions) that tell the Import File Modifier what to add or change in your Import File. There are two types of Rule Sets:

- **Add Fields Rule Set** - Contains instructions for adding one or more fields to an Import File.
- **Change Fields Rule Set** - Contains instructions for changing data in, or adding data to, fields in an Import File.

This section provides instructions for building each type of Rule Set. If you're unfamiliar with Rule Sets, refer to About Rule Sets for more information and examples.

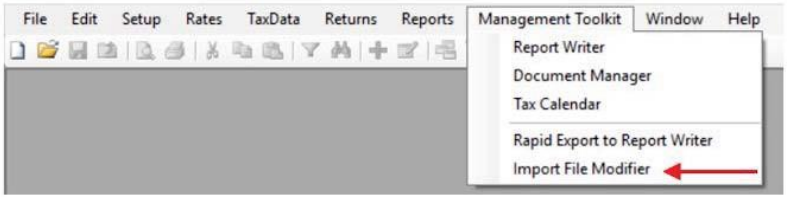
Note: *If you want to add new fields* **and** *populate them with data, you must build both types of Rule Sets and modify the original Import File twice. Refer to Using both Rule Sets.*

Building an Add Fields Rule Set

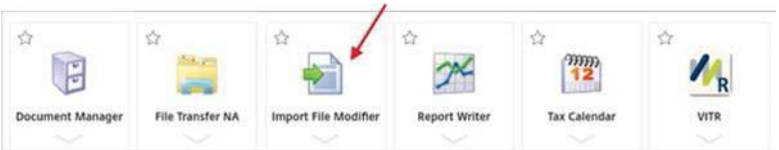
An Add Fields Rule Set contains one or more instructions for adding new fields to a third-party tax data Import File.

Note: *If you are unfamiliar with this type of Rule Set, refer to About Rule Sets for more information and examples.*

1. Click **Management Toolkit > Import File Modifier**.



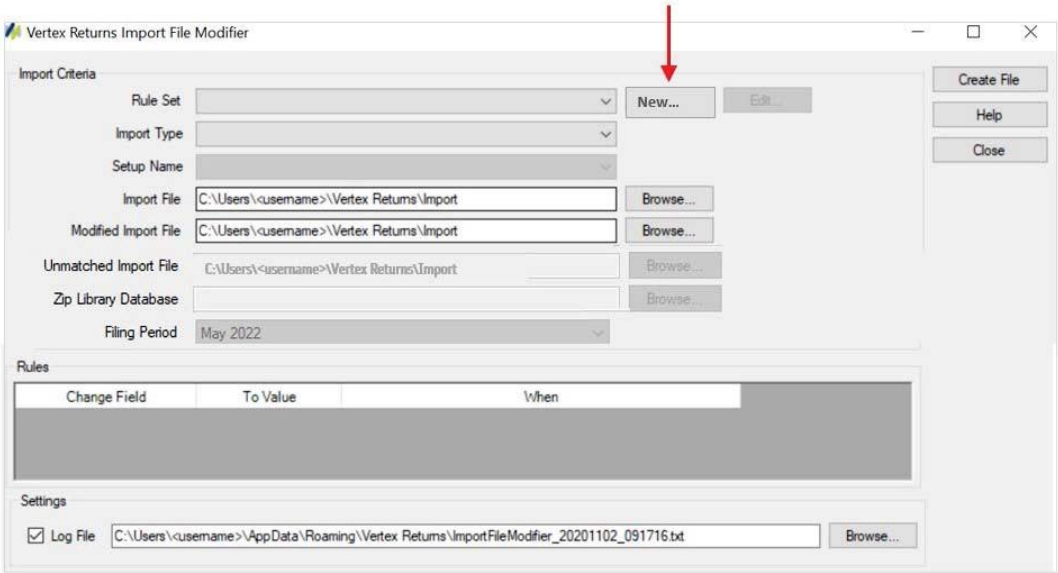
Note: *On-Demand users must click the Import File Modifier icon on the landing page.*



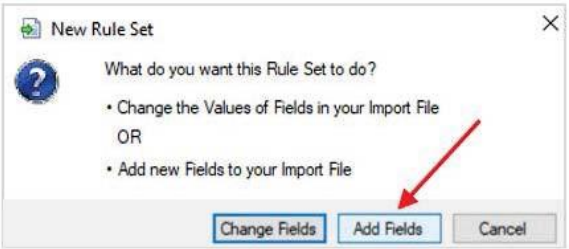
2. Select a Returns Database and click **Connect**.

Note: *Because the Import File Modifier is a separate application, it doesn't automatically connect to a TaxApp database. You can select the database currently in use by TaxApp or a different database.*

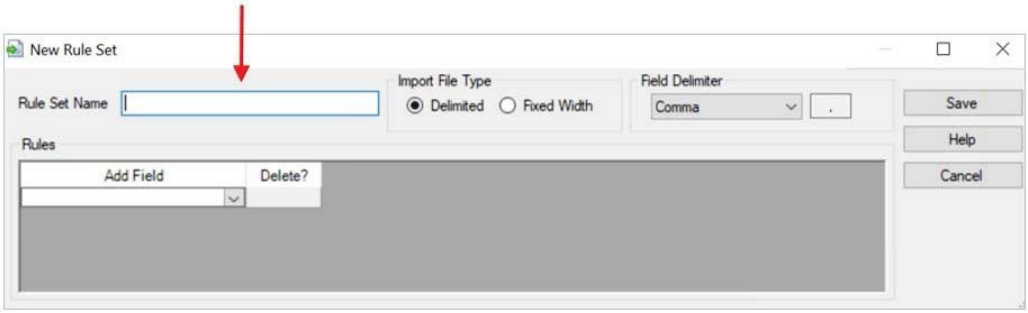
3. Click **New...** in the Import File Modifier window.



4. Click **Add Fields**.

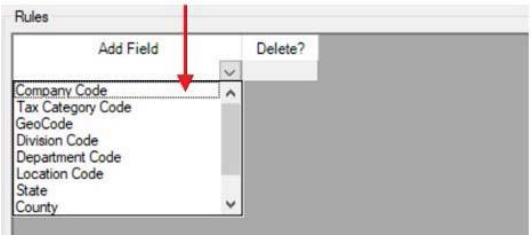


5. Enter a **Rule Set Name**.



6. If your Import File *is not* comma delimited (CSV or TXT file with commas between fields), then you must identify the file format:
   - Select a **Field Delimiter** if you have a TXT file with fields that are separated by a "non-comma" character.
   - Select **Fixed Width** if your file uses columns to separate fields.

7. In the Rules table, click the blank field under **Add Fields** to activate the list.



Note: *If the Rule Set is for a fixed width Import File, the table also includes a* **Width** *column for your information. You cannot change the* **Width***.*

- Select a field to add to the Import File.
- If you are adding multiple fields, you must select them in the order that you want them to appear in the Import File.

Note: *You cannot change an* ***Add Field*** *selection. You must delete the row and re-enter your selection.*

8. When your selections are complete:
   - Verify that the fields are listed in the order they need to appear in the file.
   - Click **Save**.

   The Import File Modifier window displays the instructions for your new Rule Set in the Rules table.

   Note: *The Rules table contains one column for delimited Import Files and two columns for fixed width files (see step 6).*

This completes the process of building an Add Fields Rule Set.

Next Steps

You need to create an Import Setup that includes mappings for the new fields. When that is complete, you can do either of the following:

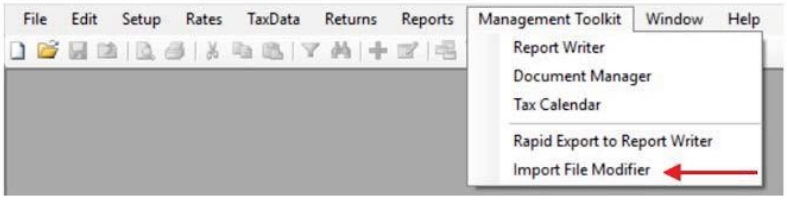
- Build a Change Fields Rule Set to populate the new fields. Then import the resulting file into TaxApp.
- Import the file into TaxApp without populating the new fields.

Building a Change Fields Rule Set

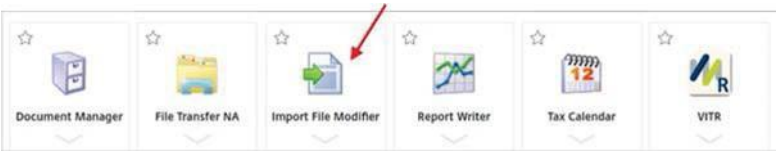
A Change Fields Rule Set contains instructions for changing data in, or adding data to, the existing fields in your Import File.

Note: *If you are unfamiliar with this type of Rule Set, refer to [About Rule Sets](#) for more information and examples.*

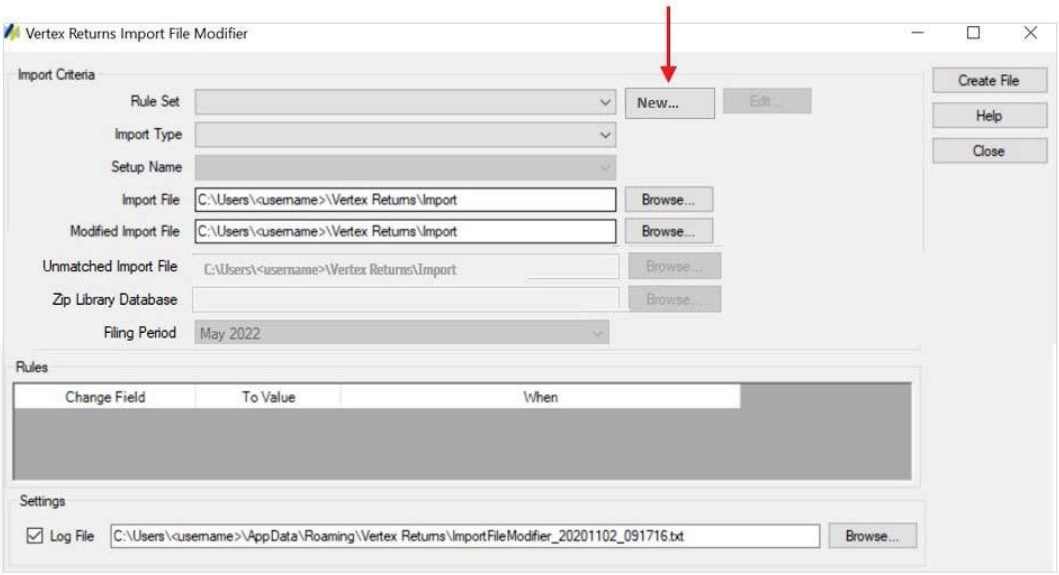
1. Click **Management Toolkit > Import File Modifier**.



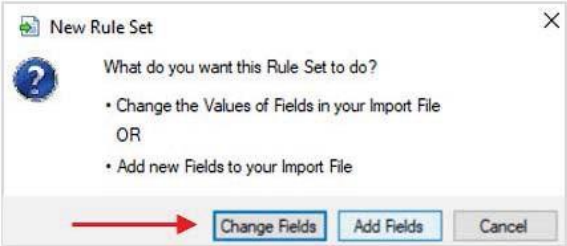
Note: *On-Demand users must click the Import File Modifier icon on the landing page.*



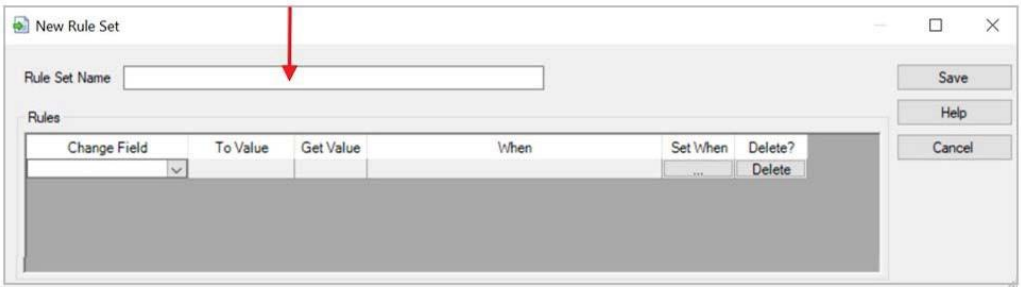
2. Select a Returns Database and click **Connect**.
   - Because the Import File Modifier is a separate application, it doesn't automatically connect a TaxApp database.
   - You can select the database currently in use by TaxApp or a different database.
   - If you are importing a third-party tax data file, you must select the database that contains the Import Setup for your Import File.
3. Click **New...** in the Import File Modifier window.



4. Click **Change Fields**.



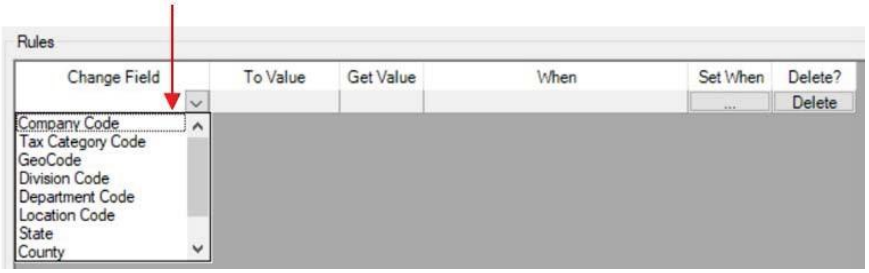
5. Enter a **Rule Set Name**.



6. Click **Change Field** and select the name of the Import File field that you want to modify.

   Example: If you want to change the Tax Category Code to 789 in your Import File, select Tax Category Code from the list.

   Note: *The field you select must be mapped in the [Import Setup]() for your Import File. Otherwise, the Rule is ignored.*

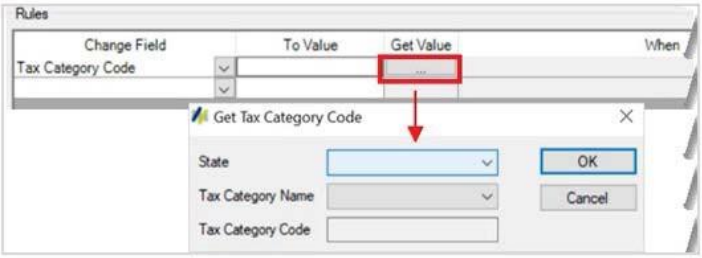


   This activates the other fields in the row and adds a new blank row.

7. Populate the **To Value** field with the new value for the **Change Field** using one of these methods:

   - **Method 1** *(Recommended)* - Click the **Get Value** field and select a value from the list. This ensures that you select a valid value.

     Example: If you want to change the Tax Category Code to 789, select the State, and then select 789 from the Tax Category Code list.



- **Method 2** - Manually enter a value directly in the **To Value** field.

Note: *The application does not verify manually entered values.*

Example: If you mistakenly enter 889 instead of 789, an invalid Tax Category Code will be added to your Import File.

8. Decide if your Rule needs Conditions to restrict the Import File records that can be modified.
   - A Rule without Conditions is a global rule, which modifies all records in the Import File.

     Example: The Rule "Change Tax Category Code to 789" will overwrite all Tax Category Codes in the Import File with 789.
   - A Rule with Conditions will change only records that meet a predefined set of criteria.

     Example: If you want to change the Tax Category Code to 789 only for Company ABC, then you need to add a Condition for Company ABC.
9. If your Rule requires Conditions, proceed to Creating Conditions.
10. If your Rule *does not* require Conditions:
    - Click **Save**.

      The Import File Modifier window displays the instructions for your new Rule Set in the Rules Table.
    - Proceed to Applying a Rule Set.